

Topic 1.1 – Landscape Systems

“Life is like a landscape. You live in the midst of it but can describe it only from the vantage point of distance.” – Charles Lindbergh

This topic introduces learners to the integrated study of Earth surface processes, landforms and resultant landscapes within the conceptual framework of a systems approach.

An understanding of Earth surface processes, together with their associated transfers of energy and movements of materials underpins the landscape systems topic.

Choosing **one** of either **Option A** coastal, **Option B** glaciated or **Option C** dryland landscapes, learners will explore how the landscape can be viewed as system, how landforms developed within their chosen landscape and the influences of both climate and human activity on this.

For all options within this topic, study **must** include at least **two** case studies from landscapes beyond the UK and at least **one** landscape from the UK.